

Volkswagen (VOWG_p.DE): 2Q26 operating miss, EPS further burdened by tax while auto cash flow beat; growth outlook revised down

Volkswagen reported 2Q26 results today (24th of July). We expect VW 2026 consensus EPS to see LSD downgrades mechanically on lower growth ambitions (now -3%-0% prior 0%-3%). We remain Neutral rated.

Operating miss driven by Progressive/Luxury and special costs: VW reported 2Q26 group op. profit of €3.47bn, 10% below company-compiled consensus (€3.85bn, GSe €4.04bn) while revenues were 1.3% above expectations, leading to an 4.2% RoS (cons 4.7%, GSe 5.0%). The miss was largely driven by a miss in Brand Group Progressive (-29% below EBIT cons) burdened by residual value revaluation effects and Luxury Brand beat by 12%. The operating line was also burdened by a low 3-digit (GSe €100mn) one-off cost related to the discontinued Bosch partnership. Meanwhile, Brand Group Core beat expectations on operating result by 8.5% (cons €1.91bn, GSe €2.23bn). China proportionate at-equity income for the 2Q stood at €101mn (GSe €35mn). On EPS (prefs) level, VW missed expectations, reporting €2.56 (cons €4.70, GSe €4.75) as a negative financial result and a higher tax rate mainly dragged below operating line results.

Strong 2Q cash flow beat: 2Q cash flow came in 101% above expectations (cons €583mn, GSe -€592mn). The better-than-expected auto net cash flow was driven by €1.5bn lower cash consumption in working capital, €0.9bn lower investment in capex/R&D, €0.1bn lower M&A expense and the -€0.9bn Rivian investment being slightly offset by the Sinotruk stake sale by €0.3bn. 2Q auto cash R&D was €4.68bn (GSe €4.96bn) with capitalized development costs of €2.08bn (GSe €2.25bn) lifting PnL by €99mn (GSe €147mn).

2026 outlook adjusted on top-line: The company adjusted its outlook, now expecting lower sales revenue -3%-0% (prior 0-3%) but maintained its operating margin of 4.0-5.5%. Cash flow guidance and net liquidity also remains unchanged despite the strong 2Q performance. The company highlights that these estimates do not factor potential effects arising from development and implementation of the Group Target Picture 2030 as well as the announced Everllence stake sale.

Key questions for the call: 1) Progress and execution of ongoing cost initiatives; 2) Updates on Everllence sale process and potential other cash return opportunities in FY26; 3) Outlook on China JV business and competitive landscape; 4) European competitive landscape

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Volkswagen vs GSe and consensus

Exhibit 1: VW 2Q26 vs GSe and company-compiled consensus

€ mn	2Q26						2026E		
	Reported	GSe	Cons	Reported vs. GSe	Reported vs. Cons	GSe vs. Cons	GSe	Cons	GSe vs. Cons
Revenue									
Brand Group Core	38,161	37,601	36,855	1.5%	3.5%	2.0%	145,492	145,597	-0.1%
Brand Group Progressive	14,999	17,532	16,493	-14.4%	-9.1%	6.3%	64,870	65,281	-0.6%
Brand Group Sport Luxury	7,777	8,243	7,842	-5.7%	-0.8%	5.1%	31,944	31,225	2.3%
Brand Group Trucks	11,310	10,719	11,156	5.5%	1.4%	-3.9%	44,235	44,008	0.5%
VW Financial Services	15,743	14,424	15,396	9.1%	2.3%	-6.3%	62,417	61,255	1.9%
Other Segments	-5,546	28,106	-6,365	NA	NA	NA	-22,070	-24,740	NA
Group	82,444	81,283	81,377	1.4%	1.3%	-0.1%	326,887	322,626	1.3%
Operating Profit									
Brand Group Core	2,070	2,276	1,908	-9.0%	8.5%	19.3%	7,325	6,936	5.6%
Brand Group Progressive	533	635	750	-16.1%	-29.0%	-15.3%	3,438	3,699	-7.1%
Brand Group Sport Luxury	692	704	621	-1.7%	11.5%	13.4%	2,005	1,856	8.0%
Brand Group Trucks	902	765	771	17.9%	17.0%	-0.7%	2,675	2,599	3.0%
VW Financial Services	805	824	846	-2.3%	-4.8%	-2.5%	3,531	3,630	-2.7%
Other Segments	-1,533	3,093	-1,048	NA	NA	NA	-4,481	-4,600	NA
Group	3,469	4,041	3,848	-14.2%	-9.8%	5.0%	14,494	14,120	2.6%
Operating margin, %									
Brand Group Core	5.4%	6.1%	5.2%	-0.6%	0.2%	0.9%	5.0%	4.8%	0.3%
Brand Group Progressive	3.6%	3.6%	4.5%	-0.1%	-1.0%	-0.9%	5.3%	5.7%	-0.4%
Brand Group Sport Luxury	8.9%	8.5%	7.9%	0.4%	1.0%	0.6%	6.3%	5.9%	0.3%
Brand Group Trucks	8.0%	7.1%	6.9%	0.8%	1.1%	0.2%	6.0%	5.9%	0.1%
VW Financial Services	5.1%	5.7%	5.5%	-0.6%	-0.4%	NA	5.7%	5.9%	NA
Other Segments	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Group	4.2%	5.0%	4.7%	-0.8%	-0.5%	0.2%	4.4%	4.4%	0.1%
Reported EPS (prefs)	2.56	4.75	4.70	-46.1%	-45.5%	1.2%	17.25	17.49	-1.4%
Auto Cash Flow Reported	1,172	-592	583	297.8%	101.0%	-201.6%	5,190	5,124	1.3%
Automotive Net Liquidity	32,750	31,025	31,624	5.6%	3.6%	-1.9%	34,815	34,590	0.6%

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Valuation and Key risks

Valuation & Key Risks

We value Volkswagen using a P/E-based approach, applying a target multiple of 4.0x (in line with our approach to its European mass-market peers) to our blended 27/28E EPS, to derive a 12-month price target of €89. We remain Neutral-rated on the stock.

Upside risks:

- Stronger improvement in European demand
- Macro concerns, notably with respect to Europe, do not materialise
- Accelerated BEV adoption and cost curve benefits
- Corporate reorganisation
- Tariff relief or regulatory easing
- China performance stabilisation
- Investors start to take a SoTP approach to valuing VW, thereby crediting the equity value of Porsche AG

Downside risks:

- Software and BEV production issues
- New products less well-received than recent products
- Supply-chain constraints
- Commodity and energy prices
- Geopolitics
- China slowdown
- Pricing pressure and increased competition

VOWG_p.DE	12m Price Target: €89.00	Price: €72.94	Upside: 22.0%
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Neutral		GS Forecast			
		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Market cap: €36.8bn / \$41.9bn	Revenue (€ mn)	321,913.5	326,886.7	336,154.4	342,587.7
Enterprise value: €53.3bn / \$61.2bn	EBIT (€ mn)	8,868.0	14,493.7	17,121.6	19,408.3
3m ADTV: €82.9mn / \$95.7mn	EPS (€)	13.35	17.25	20.94	23.62
Germany	EV/EBITDA (X)	4.3	3.7	3.4	3.1
Europe Autos	P/E (X)	7.2	4.2	3.5	3.1
M&A Rank: 3	Dividend yield (%)	5.5	7.1	8.4	9.5
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes	FCF yield (%)	(12.1)	8.5	13.6	13.0
	CROCI (%)	(0.5)	3.8	4.0	4.0
	Net debt/EBITDA (X)	(1.0)	(0.9)	(1.0)	(1.1)
		3/26	6/26E	9/26E	12/26E
		2.61	4.75	2.78	7.11

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 23 Jul 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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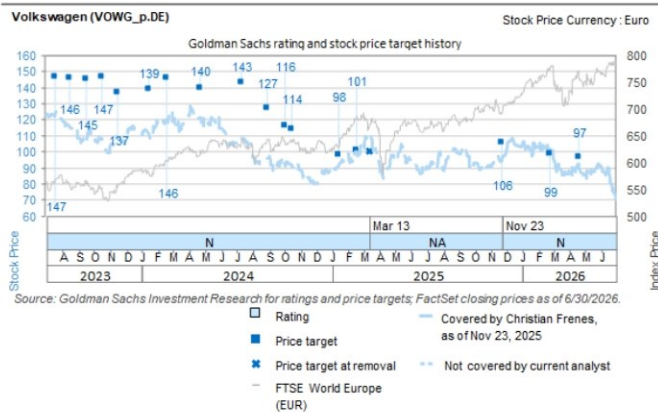
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Volkswagen (VOWG_p.DE)

Date of report	Target price (€)	Closing price (€)
15-Jul-26	89.00	74.40
20-Apr-26	97.00	90.48
24-Feb-26	99.00	101.60
23-Nov-25	106.00	94.72
18-Feb-25	101.00	100.30
14-Jan-25	98.00	91.88
16-Oct-24	114.00	91.24
02-Oct-24	116.00	92.84
30-Aug-24	127.00	96.18
12-Jul-24	143.00	108.55
22-Apr-24	140.00	121.30
19-Feb-24	146.00	119.98
16-Jan-24	139.00	111.28
17-Nov-23	137.00	108.84
18-Oct-23	147.00	107.62
18-Sep-23	145.00	107.44
16-Aug-23	146.00	115.10

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